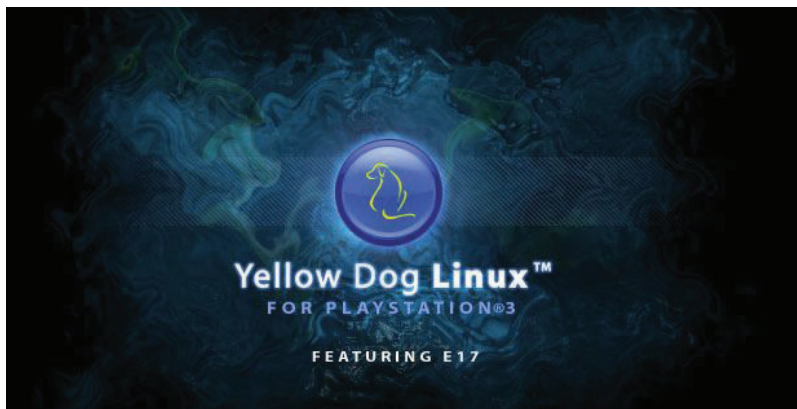




The PS3 could very easily function as a full-fledged PC

how well it ran. If you connected up a keyboard and a mouse, the PS3 could very easily function as a full-fledged PC!

Of course, YellowDog has still not been able to take full advantage of the eight cores of the Cell Processor, and hence the 256MB RAM seems a bit weak at times. But the guys at FixStars are continually updating the software to take full advantage of this mighty processor.

2.1.5 WHY IT SUCKS

Programming – in terms of hardware, the PlayStation 3 is almost unbeatable. Three years after its launch, it is still considered to be more powerful than many new computers with processors from Intel and AMD. However, the Cell Processor did lead to a significant liability for the console – the ire of game developers.

In designing the console's hardware, Sony paid little heed to the software and has since rued the decision. The eight cores and the complicated kernels made it very difficult to come out with a software development kit (SDK) that game programmers could warm to.

In 2007, Gabe Newell of Valve – which develops games such as *Half Life* and *Counter Strike*, said: "The PS3 is a total disaster on so many levels, I think it's really clear that Sony lost track of what customers and developers wanted. I'd say, even at this late date, they should just cancel it and do a do over. Just say, 'This was a horrible disaster and we're sorry and we're going to stop selling this and stop trying to convince people to develop for it'".

Doug Lombardi, the VP of Marketing for Valve, has since stated that it is interested in developing for the console and are looking to hire talented PS3 programmers for future projects. However he stated, "Until we have the ability to get a PS3 team together, until we find the people who want to come to Valve or